

A

Verb + *-ing* form

A number of verbs are commonly followed by an *-ing* form.

QUESTIONNAIRE

QUESTIONS	ANSWERS
• Do you enjoy studying?	Yes, I do.
• Do you mind getting up early? [Is it OK for you, or not?]	No, I don't mind at all.
• Do you like or dislike having your photograph taken?	I hate having my picture taken.
• Do you usually avoid speaking to strangers at parties? [try not to do something]	Yes. I prefer to talk to people that I already know.
• Can you imagine being without a car? [think of yourself in a situation with no car]	No, I can't. I need my car.
• Have you ever considered [thought about] living in another country?	Yes, many times. I'd like to live abroad.
• Would you recommend [advise] having a holiday in the capital city of your country? If so, would you suggest going at a particular time of the year?	Yes, I would, and I would suggest going in spring or autumn.

Common mistakes

I enjoy going there. (NOT I enjoy to go there.) They suggested leaving early. (NOT They suggested to leave early.) He recommended staying there. (NOT He recommended to stay there.)

B

Verb + *to* infinitive

I **hope** to see them next week. [want to see them and believe I will see them]

They **agreed** to help me. [said they will help]

I **intend** to leave next month. [plan]

I **offered** to help them. [said I was happy to help]

I **attempted** to cook the dinner, but it was terrible. [tried]

I **promised** to bring her book back. [said I would definitely bring it back]

The shop assistant was very rude, so I **demanded** to see the manager. [said in a firm way]

C

Verb + (object) + preposition + noun/*-ing*

A: Jo has just rung and **asked** me **for** advice about Greece. They're **thinking of**¹ going there.

B: Well, be careful. They went to India last year on your advice and then **blamed**² you **for** the terrible holiday they had.

A: That was their fault. They **insisted on**³ going in the summer when it was far too hot.

¹ thinking about going to Greece (often used in the continuous and followed by a noun/*-ing* form; NOT I'm thinking to go there.)

² said you were responsible for something bad, in this case the terrible holiday

³ said they must go (in the summer)